

Wasting Time 39

Learn of interesting ways to spend time on the Internet.

80legs fee:

\$2 per million pages scanned, plus 3 cents per CPU hour

Host photos 80

A roundup of the best image hosting sites

clips", which lets you save ten-second clips of various in-game accomplishments to share.

OnLive demoed 16 high-end titles which included *Crysis*, *Burnout Paradise*, and *Grand Theft Auto IV*. If you're wondering about the reaction of game studios to this technology you'd be surprised. Electronic Arts, Ubisoft, Take-Two Interactive, Warner Bros. Interactive Entertainment, THQ, Epic Games, Eidos, Atari Interactive and Codemasters have already joined the bandwagon. What would be interesting is the reaction of hardware manufacturers. Theoretically, since processing is done in the cloud, OnLive can make sure you never have to upgrade your PC. So bye bye high-end graphics card, see you quad core, adios gigabytes of memory? Will NVIDIA, ATI and Intel loose sleep over this? Maybe and maybe not. Because even if the games are not running in your system and are running in the cloud, they are still running somewhere on some hardware. Of course this hardware will be consolidated and have better utilisation rates. What about console manufacturers? They are certainly the first candidates for losing sleep.

Yet we'll have to wait and watch before ideas become a reality. Given how



much trouble it is to encode and decode video, several critics are suggesting that this technology is unworkable. In its defence, OnLive has stated that apart from special algorithms, it has employed a custom built silicon chip that does encoding at the server end and decompression at user end in milliseconds. Besides, transmitting such compressed data over an open internet connection poses its own problems. It will probably result in the

need for a user to be in the geographical proximity of an OnLive server farm.

OnLive will be a subscription-based service, but since it's still in beta, pricing hasn't yet been revealed. Subscription models will probably let you play games for a certain amount of time or buy them outright for unlimited plays. The Bluetooth enabled device for playing on HDTV, (MicroConsole) will probably cost as much as any other console such as a Wii.

Web 2.0 Expo

Sometime in the first half of April, the third instalment of the Web 2.0 Expo came to quite a fruitful end in San Francisco. A yearly fixture now, the expo plays host to web designers, developers, entrepreneurs, marketers, business strategists, and venture capitalists; all connected within the all-consuming purview of Web 2.0.

This year, the response was a bit lukewarm, with attendee numbers dropping from around 10,000 last year to about 8,000 this time around. Who would want to physically attend an expo when every-

of some of the most promising ideas presented at Web 2.0 Expo 09:

80legs: the most innovative of all the ideas presented. It is a web-scale platform for content discovery (crawling) and analysis. So developers, entrepreneurs, in fact anyone, can use 80legs to analyse the internet at lightning fast speeds (2 billion pages per day on a 50,000-node supercomputer). The possibilities are limitless. You could use it to understand web trends, scan for content, and perhaps it could spawn new search engines. It'll be interest-

DubMeNow: is another step forward towards syncing mobile contacts with the web. It allows you to create a mobile business card which you can share with anyone through the cloud. In turn your contact's info loads directly into your existing mobile address book and is automatically updated whenever your contact changes their information. "Do away with visiting cards" seems to be the motto.

Bantam Networks: This is an online workspace for businesses, that features work flow management. So, basically,



thing from the keynote to closing can be found on the web within a few hours?

In the past, the conference has seen many exceptional ideas and technologies being showcased to the world for the first time, such as Zimbra, Flock and JobScore. Even with the current state of the economy, Launchpad, the startup podium, received about 80 entries. The approach this time was different, also reflecting the plight of the economy. Instead of the VC focus of previous years, this time the focus was on the end user. Here is a roundup

ing to see how this new platform can be used productively, if at all.

PhoneGap: launched by Nitobi, this one was the crowd favourite. PhoneGap is an open source framework that allows developers to author apps in HTML and JavaScript, while leveraging device capabilities such as camera, vibration and sound. So what's the big deal? PhoneGap apps are supposed to run on the iPhone, Android and Blackberry.

business teams get to create secure social workspaces where you access features such as information sharing, activity tracking, file storage, task lists and so on. Bantam also pulls in content from other Web 2.0 sources like Twitter and LinkedIn.

ZeaLog: A personal tracking app that is supposed to help you achieve any specific personal goal such as quit smoking, loose weight, drink more water, etc.

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